5/8/25

Madam rides the Bus

-Vallikkannan

I Answer the following Word Meanings:-

a Slack Time: A period with little or no activity
Sentence we relaxed during the slack time at work.

b Repulsive: Causing intense dislike or disgust
Sentence The smell was absolutely repulsive to everyone.

c Hamlet: A small village or settlement
Sentence They lived in a quiet mountain hamlet.

d Gabbling: Talking quickly and unclearly
Sentence The children were gabbling excitedly after school.

e Gazed: Looked steadily and intently
Sentence She gazed at the stars in silence.

f Chit of a girl: A young, often impudent or cheeky girl.
Sentence That chit of a girl surprised everyone.

II Reference to Context:-

1 "Her first ---------- the money."

a Which journey has been mentioned in the extract?
Ans The journey mentioned is the bus travelling between Valli's village and the nearest town.

b Why did Valli resist her temptation?
Ans She resisted the temptation of a free cold drink to maintain her self respect and independence, refusing to accept any obligation from the conductor.

c Which strong desire did Valli resist?
Ans She resisted her overwhelming desire to ride the bus until she'd saved the fare and found the perfect moment to slip away while her mother napped.

d Which word from the extract means 'To spend money carefully'?
Ans

III Answer the following Short Answers:-

Q.1 How did Valli spent her leisure time?
Ans Valli spent her leisure hours standing in her front doorway, gazing at the street. She watched the bus as it passed, filled each time with new passengers, and discreetly questioned neighbours about its timings and fare, all the while imagining herself riding to the town.

Q.2 What was Valli's overwhelming desire?
ans Valli's overwhelming desire was to ride the village bus she watched daily from her doorway; that tiny wish grew into a powerful longing to experience freedom and adventure beyond her home.

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Q3 How did Valli gather information about the bus ride?

ans Valli stood at her doorway each day, watching the villge bus pass and noting passengers boarding. She caredropped on neighbours and regular riders discussing fares, schedules, and travel time. By discreetly asking questions about the thirty-paise fare, timings, and journey duration, she mentally assembled precise details until she could plan her own trip.

IV Answer the following Long Answers:-

Q1 Which painstaking effort did Valli make to execute the plan of riding a bus?

ans Valli's plan demanded meticulous thrift. She saved every stray coin and resisted buying peppermints, toys or balloons, stifling the lure of the merry-go-round. Each paise added to her growing pile until she finally had thirty paise - the one-way fare for the bus.

She gathered intelligence through quiet observation: standing at her doorway, she watched the buses pass, questioned riders about schedules and fares, and memorized the forty-five-minute journey. Armed with these details, she mapped out the perfect departure and return times to fit into her daily routine.

Finally, Valli synchronized with her mother's afternoon nap, slipping away unnoticed, clutching the saved coins in her pinafore pocket. This careful timing transformed her months of sacrifice into a moment of independance and adventure aboard the village bus.

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